



Decomposers eat plants and animals that have died. They recycle the energy from dead things back into the soil.



Omnivores can eat plants and animals. Chimps and humans are omnivores.



Herbivores eat only plants. Deer are herbivores.

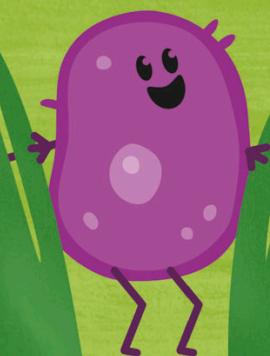


Carnivores eat only animals, which they catch or hunt. Tigers are carnivores.

This shrew eats caterpillars. If there were too many caterpillars, there would be too few plants to feed them. The shrew is helping to keep the food chain in balance.



The apex predator in this food chain is an owl, which eats shrews. Energy has moved through the food chain from the sun all the way to the owl.



Animals that are hunted and eaten are called **prey**.